

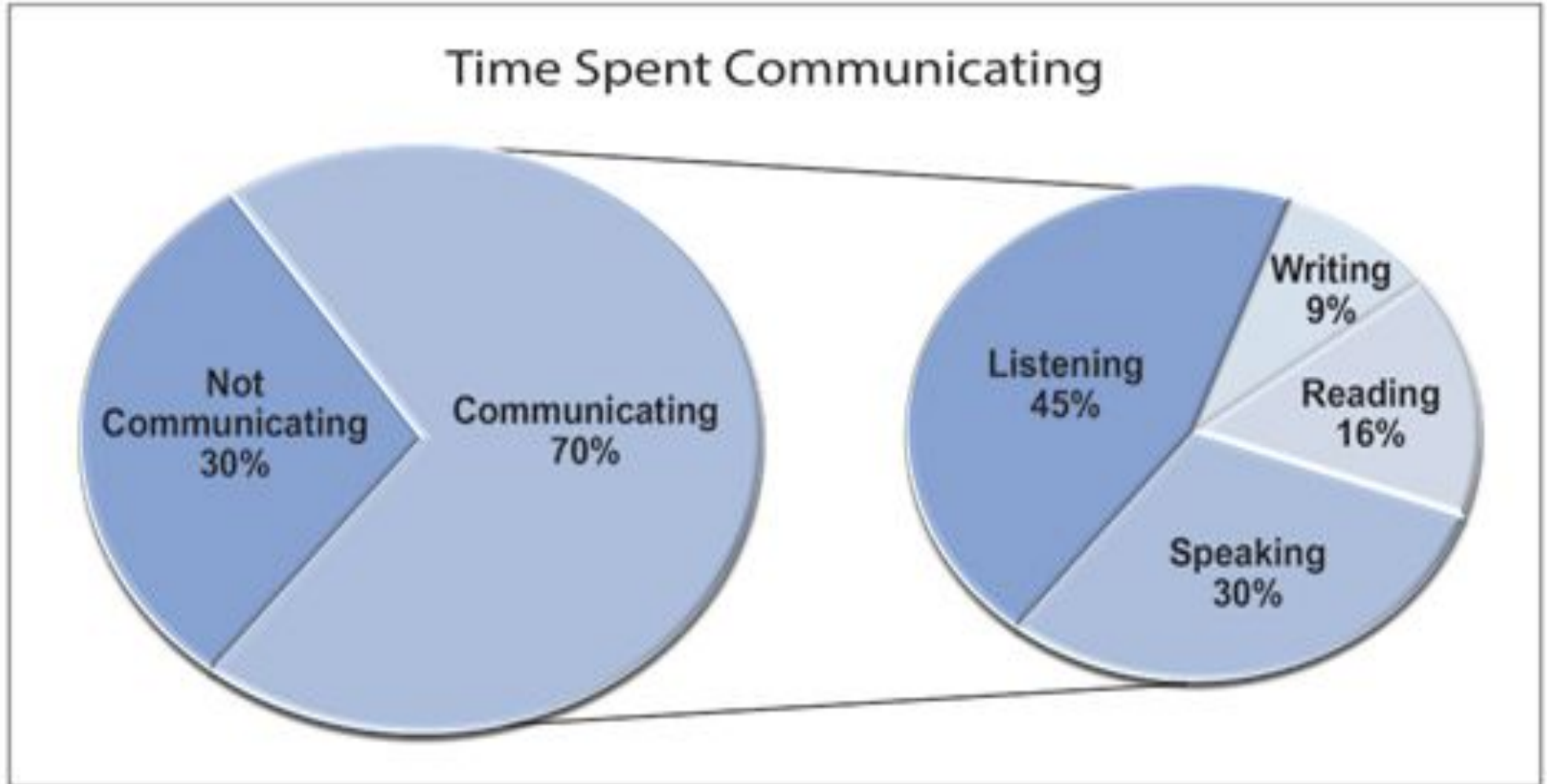
Listening skills

Listening

Listening is the ability to accurately receive and interpret messages in the communication process.

- Listening is key to all effective communication. Without the ability to listen effectively, messages are easily misunderstood.
- As a result, communication breaks down and the sender of the message can easily become frustrated or irritated.

**We spend a lot of time in listening
(Adler, R. et al. 2001).**



Listening vs. Hearing

- **Hearing** refers to the sounds that enter your ears. It is a physical process that, provided you do not have any hearing problems, happens automatically.
- **Listening**, however, requires focus and concentrated effort, both mental and sometimes physical as well.

Active listening

- Listening is not a **passive process**. In fact, the listener can, and should, be at least as engaged in the process as the speaker. The phrase '**active listening**' is used to describe this process of being fully involved.
- *The most basic and powerful way to connect to another person is to listen. Just listen. Perhaps the most important thing we ever give each other is our attention.*

Active listening...

- Active listening involves **listening with all senses**. As well as giving full attention to the speaker, it is important that the 'active listener' is also '**seen**' to be listening - otherwise the speaker may conclude that what they are talking about is **uninteresting** to the listener.

Active listening...

Interest can be conveyed to the speaker by using both verbal and non-verbal messages such as maintaining eye contact, nodding your head and smiling, agreeing by saying 'Yes' or simply 'Mmm, hmm' to encourage them to continue.

By providing this 'feedback' the person speaking will usually feel more at ease and therefore communicate more easily, openly and honestly.

Signs of active listening

Non-verbal signs of active Listening are:

- Smile
- Eye Contact
- Posture
- Mirroring
- Positive Reinforcement
- Remembering
- Questioning
- Reflection
- Clarification
- Summarization

General Listening Types

The two main types of listening - the foundations of all listening sub-types are:

- Discriminative Listening
- Comprehensive Listening

Discriminative Listening

- Discriminative listening develops through childhood and into adulthood. As we grow older and develop and gain more life experience, our ability to distinguish between different sounds is improved.
- Not only can we recognize different voices, but we also develop the ability to recognize subtle differences in the way that sounds are made – this is fundamental to ultimately understanding what these sounds mean.

Comprehensive Listening

- Comprehensive listening involves understanding the message or messages that are being communicated.
- Comprehensive listening is complimented by sub-messages from non-verbal communication, such as the tone of voice, gestures and other body language

Specific Listening Types (Interpersonal)

- Informational Listening (Listening to Learn)
- Critical Listening (Listening to evaluate and analyze)
- Therapeutic or Empathetic Listening (Listening to understand feeling and emotion)

Process of Listening

- 1. **Receiving**
- It refers to the response caused by sound waves stimulating the sensory receptors of the ear; it is a physical response.
- 2 **Understanding**
- It is the stage at which you learn what the speaker means “The thoughts and emotional tone.

- 3.Remembering

- It is important listening process because it means that as individual added message to the minds storage bank.

- 4.Evaluating

- It consists of judging the message in some way.

- 5.Responding

- This stage requires that the receiver complete the process through verbal and/or nonverbal feedback; because the speaker has no other way to determine if a message has been received. This stage becomes the only overt means by which the sender may determine the degree of success in transmitting the message.

Techniques of Listening Skills

- Focus on key-points.
- Being aware of both verbal and non-verbal messages.
- Listen with an open mind.
- Avoid false attention and pretending to listen.
- Wait for the speaker to pause to ask clarifying question.
- Be attentive, but relaxed.

Listening pitfalls (Barriers)

- Appearance and delivery
- Separating ideas from facts
- Interrupting
- Pretending
- Distraction
- Sarcasm

Rules of Good Listening

- Stop talking
- Stop thinking
- Remove Distractions
- Do not let your Mind Wander
- Do not Pre-judge
- Be Patient
- Empathize with the speaker

Thank You